

CYBER SECURITY TASK 02

PART D – THREAT IDENTIFICATION

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1. Insider Threat

Description : An insider threat occurs when a current or former employee, student, or contractor intentionally or accidentally misuses their authorized access, leading to the exposure, theft, or damage of sensitive information.

Possible Impact :

- Leakage of confidential data.
- Financial loss and damage to the organization's reputation.
- Unauthorized changes to important records.

Prevention Methods :

- Implement the principle of least privilege (users receive only the access they need).
- Monitor user activities and maintain audit logs.
- Conduct regular cybersecurity awareness training.
- Remove access immediately when employees leave the organization

2. Malware

Description : Malware is malicious software designed to damage systems, steal data, or disrupt normal computer operations. Common types include viruses, worms, trojans, spyware, and ransomware.

Possible Impact :

- Loss or theft of sensitive information.
- System slowdown or complete failure.
- Files may be encrypted or permanently deleted.

Prevention Methods :

- Install and regularly update antivirus software.
- Keep operating systems and applications up to date.
- Avoid downloading files from untrusted sources.
- Perform regular backups of important data.

3. Phishing

Description : Phishing is a cyberattack in which attackers send fake emails, messages, or websites that appear legitimate to trick users into revealing passwords, banking details, or other sensitive information.

Possible Impact :

- Stolen login credentials.
- Identity theft and financial fraud.
- Unauthorized access to organizational systems.

Prevention Methods :

- Train users to recognize phishing attempts.
- Verify suspicious emails before clicking links or attachments.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Use email filtering and anti-phishing security tools.

4. Weak Passwords

Description : Weak passwords are easy to guess or crack because they are short, predictable, or reused across multiple accounts.

Possible Impact :

- Unauthorized access to user accounts.
- Data breaches and information theft.
- Increased risk of account compromise.

Prevention Methods :

- Use strong and unique passwords for every account.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Use a password manager to generate and store secure passwords.
- Change passwords if they are suspected to be compromised.

5. Unpatched Systems

Description : Unpatched systems are computers or software that have not received the latest security updates. Attackers often exploit these known vulnerabilities to gain unauthorized access.

Possible Impact :

- Malware infections and ransomware attacks.
- Unauthorized access to systems and data.
- Service disruptions and operational downtime.

Prevention Methods :

- Install security updates and patches regularly.
- Enable automatic updates whenever possible.
- Perform routine vulnerability assessments.
- Maintain an organized patch management process.

Conclusion :

These threats are among the most common cybersecurity risks faced by organizations. Understanding their causes, impacts, and prevention methods helps organizations strengthen their security posture and reduce the likelihood of successful cyberattacks.